

Date of Preparation: May 26th, 2026

Christina Laternser, Ph.D.

Biostatistician & Health Economist | Pediatric Cardiology & Health Economics

CONTACT INFORMATION

Business Address: Ann & Robert H. Lurie Children's Hospital of Chicago
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EDUCATION

2016 – 2022	Ph.D., Economics (University of Chicago Scholar) University of Illinois at Chicago, Chicago, IL
2016 – 2018	M.A., Economics University of Illinois at Chicago, Chicago, IL
2012 – 2014	M.S., Economics and Public Analysis DePaul University, Chicago, IL
2010 – 2011	M.S., Mathematics Fairfield University, Fairfield, CT
2006 – 2010	B.S. Mathematics (Major); Politics, Philosophy (Minors) Fairfield University, Fairfield, CT

ACADEMIC & PROFESSIONAL POSITIONS

2021 – Present	Biostatistician and Health Economist Ann & Robert H. Lurie Children's Hospital of Chicago, Department of Pediatrics, Chicago, IL Conduct independent and collaborative research on healthcare access, outcomes, and system structure; develop statistical and econometric models; lead study design and analysis.
2018 – 2022	Research Assistant University of Illinois at Chicago, Chicago, IL
2016 – 2022	Teaching Assistant University of Illinois at Chicago, Chicago, IL
2011 – 2023	Adjunct Faculty, Mathematics and Economics DePaul University; Columbia College Chicago, Chicago, IL
2013 – 2014	International Actuarial Analyst Towers Watson, Chicago, IL

RESEARCH INTERESTS

Health services research; healthcare access and system structure; industrial organization of healthcare markets; pharmaceutical regulation and generic competition; perinatal and pediatric health systems.

HONORS & AWARDS

2025 **Second Place, Young Investigator Award**, American Academy of Pediatrics National Conference and Exhibition. Awarded for abstract: *Are discharge barriers responsible for insurance-based differences in length of stay after congenital heart surgery?* (Laternser C, Zdanowicz Z, Lay A, Woo J)

2020 Elizabeth Bass Award

2010 Received highest score on the University-wide Mathematics Comprehensive Examination, Fairfield University

2006 – 2010 **Graduated with Distinction**, Fairfield University Honors Program
Pi Mu Epsilon (Mathematics) | Pi Sigma Alpha (Political Science) | Phi Sigma Tau (Philosophy) | Phi Kappa Phi (Outstanding Academic Achievement) | Beta Gamma Sigma (Business Excellence)

PROFESSIONAL/HONOR SOCIETY MEMBERSHIPS

Pi Mu Epsilon (Mathematics Honor Society)
Pi Sigma Alpha (Political Science Honor Society)
Phi Sigma Tau (Philosophy Honor Society)
Phi Kappa Phi (Outstanding Academic Achievement)
Beta Gamma Sigma (Business Excellence)

PROFESSIONAL SERVICE

Journal Peer Review

Reviewer, Journal of Visualized Experiments (JoVE), 2026

Invited Talks

Invited Speaker, “Regulatory Design and Strategic Patenting Under the Hatch-Waxman Act,” 10th Annual Boston University TPRI IP Day, Boston, MA. July 20, 2026.

TEACHING & MENTORING

2011 – 2023 **Adjunct Faculty** — Mathematics and Economics
DePaul University and Columbia College Chicago
Prepared and delivered lectures; managed classroom activities and group work to support student success in quantitative methods and economic theory.

2016 – 2022 **Teaching Assistant** — Economics
University of Illinois at Chicago
Developed course materials and virtual forums; managed sections of up to 180 students; completed PhD comprehensive examinations in Microeconomics, Macroeconomics, Econometrics, Public Finance/Health Economics, and International Macroeconomics/Time Series Analysis.

GRANTS & SPONSORED RESEARCH

2022–Present
Biostatistician PhD, Heart Center
Ann & Robert H. Lurie Children’s Hospital

PUBLICATIONS & SCHOLARLY WORKS

Note: Author name in bold denotes Christina Laternser. Publications listed in reverse chronological order.

* denotes first author

† denotes senior (last) author

Peer-Reviewed Journal Articles (N=21; first author=3; senior author=2)

A. Peer-Reviewed Original Investigations

- Lawson AA, Lottes RG, Magnetta D, Watanabe K, Rigsby CK, Markl M, **Laternser** C, Husain N, Robinson JD. Serial CMR findings in pediatric heart transplant recipients. *Journal of Cardiovascular Magnetic Resonance* 28. 2026.
- O'Halloran CP, Alsaied T, Wang AP, Ward K, **Laternser** C, Files MD, et al. Fontan conduit cross-sectional area and relationship to exercise performance. *Journal of Cardiovascular Magnetic Resonance* 102729. 2026.
- Haregu A, Watanabe K, Hauck A, **Laternser** C, Husain N. Left atrial function correlates with fibrosis in pediatric heart transplant recipients. *Echocardiography* 42(7):e70234. 2025.
- Laternser** C*, Grobman WA, Albaro C, Anderson BR, Batton B, Yee LM, Woo JL. Prenatal care and perinatal regionalization for congenital heart defects. *JAMA Network Open* 8(11):e2542135. 2025.
- Laternser** C*, Anderson BR, Yee LM, Grobman WA, Batton B, Knepp MD, et al. Individual risk versus population incidence: a case example with congenital heart defects. *Academic Pediatrics* 103187. 2025.
- Woo JL, Gandhi R, **Laternser** C, Iyengar T, Yee LM, Grobman WA, et al. Second-trimester ultrasound receipt mediates the relationship between public insurance and prenatal diagnosis of a congenital heart defect. *Prenatal Diagnosis* 45(7):886-895. 2025.
- Lawson AA, Watanabe K, Griffin L, **Laternser** C, Markl M, Rigsby CK, Robinson JD, Husain N. Multiparametric cardiovascular magnetic resonance is associated with outcomes in pediatric heart transplant recipients. *Journal of Cardiovascular Magnetic Resonance* 27(1):101138. 2025.
- Lawson AA, Tannous P, **Laternser** C, Migally K. The estimated Fick method systematically over-estimates cardiac index compared to thermodilution in children. *Pediatric Cardiology* 46(3):713-718. 2025.
- O'Halloran CP, Hauck A, Fox J, **Laternser** C, Hoyt E, Nugent AW, et al. Side cell dilation of jailed pulmonary veins after stenting improves vessel preservation in pediatric pulmonary vein stenosis. *Catheterization and Cardiovascular Interventions* 106(3):1732-1739. 2025.
- Patel S, McBrien A, Michelfelder E, Kavanaugh-McHugh A, Samples S, **Laternser** C, et al. Current trends in fetal cardiology: results from an international benchmarking survey of fetal cardiac programs through the Fetal Heart Society research collaborative. *Pediatric Cardiology*. 2025. doi: 10.1007/s00246-025-03895-5.
- Woo JL, Gotteiner N, Anderson BR, Yee LM, Grobman WA, Davis MM, **Laternser** C†. Prenatal diagnosis mediates the relationship between disease complexity and intervention timing for congenital heart defects. *Pregnancy* 1(3):e70011. 2025.
- Aboyewa O, Popescu A, Lee S, Camarda J, Hong KP, Shah D, **Laternser** C, et al. Evaluation of wideband pulse sequences for suppressing image artifacts in children with cardiac implantable electronic devices. *Radiology: Cardiothoracic Imaging* 7(6):e250310. 2025.
- Shah A, **Laternser** C, Tatachar P, Duong P. The COVID-19 pandemic and its effects on mental health—a before, during, and after comparison using the U.S. Census Bureau's Household Pulse Survey. *International Journal of Environmental Research and Public Health* 21(10):1306. 2024.
- Birjiniuk A, Weisman AG, **Laternser** C, Camarda J, Brickman WJ, Habiby R, Patel SR. Cardiovascular manifestations of Turner syndrome: phenotypic differences between karyotype subtypes. *Pediatric Cardiology* 45(7):1407-1414. 2024.
- Woo JL, Gandhi R, Iyengar T, Yee L, Davis M, Grobman W, Johnson J, Patel A, **Laternser** C†. Disparities in prenatal diagnosis of congenital heart defects: the interplay of insurance and urbanicity. *Journal of the American Heart Association* 13(16):e035440. 2024.
- Aboyewa OB, **Laternser** C, Popescu A, Murphy N, Shah D, Monge MC, Rigsby CK, Golestanirad L, Webster RG, Kim D. Cumulative radiation dose from medical imaging in pediatric congenital heart disease patients with epicardial cardiac implantable electronic devices. *European Heart Journal – Imaging Methods and Practice* 2(1):qyae060. 2024.
- Wang AP, Husain N, Penk J, **Laternser** C, Magnetta D, Watanabe K, Hauck A. Prognostic value of RV function analysis during the interstage period in patients with hypoplastic left heart syndrome. *Pediatric Cardiology* 45(5):1120-1128. 2024.

- Woo JL, **Latarnser C**, Anderson BR, Grobman WA, Monge MC, Davis MM. Association between prenatal diagnosis and age at surgery for noncritical and critical congenital heart defects. *Circulation: Cardiovascular Quality and Outcomes* 16(9):e009638. 2023.
- Jiang F, Henry KR, Bhusal B, Sanpitak P, Webster G, Popescu A, **Latarnser C**, Kim D, Golestanirad L. Age matters: a comparative study of RF heating of epicardial and endocardial electronic devices in pediatric and adult phantoms during cardiothoracic MRI. *Diagnostics* 13(17):2847. 2023.
- Lawson AA, Watanabe K, Griffin L, **Latarnser C**, Markl M, Rigsby CK, Sojka M, Robinson JD, Husain N. Late-gadolinium enhancement is common in older pediatric heart transplant recipients and is associated with lower ejection fraction. *Journal of Cardiovascular Magnetic Resonance* 25(1):61. 2023.
- Lockhart EN, Carr M, Allen K, Samis J, Torchen L, **Latarnser C**, Bian Y, Patel S. Prevalence of abnormal hemoglobin A1c values in single ventricle patients following Fontan palliation. *Pediatric Cardiology* 44(5):1083-1091. 2023.

B. Manuscripts Under Review

- Latarnser C***. Transition dynamics of county obstetric service absence: population exposure and status changes in the United States, 2015–2023. Revise and resubmit, *Health Services Research*.
- Latarnser C***. County prevalence versus population exposure in measuring areas without maternity services: evidence from Illinois, 2015–2023. Under review, *Women's Health Issues*.
- Latarnser C***. Structural feasibility of inpatient obstetric service availability in Illinois: a cross-sectional county-level study. Under review, *Journal of Public Health Management and Practice*.
- Latarnser C***. Competing structural explanations for the distribution of hospital-based obstetric services. Revise and resubmit, *Milbank Quarterly*.
- Latarnser C***. Three-regime structure of obstetric service environments. Under review, *Maternal and Child Health Journal*.
- Latarnser C***. Maternity care deserts and the timing of prenatal care initiation. Under review, *American Journal of Public Health*.
- Woo JL, Grobman WA, Mongé MC, Anderson BR, Batton B, Yee LM, **Latarnser C†**. *Time-to-transfer and hospitalization duration for severe congenital heart defects: implications for perinatal regionalization*.
- Latarnser C***. The geometry of regulatory protection regimes in pharmaceutical markets. SSRN 6618615. Under review, *International Journal of Industrial Organization*.

C. Working Papers / Manuscripts in Preparation

Industrial Organization and Pharmaceutical Policy

- Latarnser C***. Regulatory architecture and the timing of generic competition. SSRN 6764179. Working paper.
- Latarnser C***. Regulatory design and strategic patenting under the Hatch-Waxman Act. SSRN 6036037. Working paper.
- Latarnser C***. Structural feasibility and the architecture of pharmaceutical protection regimes. SSRN 6809286. Working paper.
- Health Services Research
- Latarnser C***. Structural determinants of obstetric service availability in U.S. counties: adjudicating feasibility and vulnerability architectures. Manuscript in preparation.
- Latarnser C***. Measurement–behavior alignment in obstetric access. Manuscript in preparation.
- Latarnser C***. Accessibility is not redundancy. Manuscript in preparation.
- Latarnser C***. Structural constraints across the perinatal pathway. Manuscript in preparation.
- Latarnser C***. Measuring structural access to obstetric services. Manuscript in preparation.

D. Dissertation

Master's Thesis (Mathematics)

- Latarnser C***. Volumes in hyperbolic space. arXiv preprint arXiv:1111.2498. 2011.

Doctoral Dissertation (Economics)

Latarnser C*. A study of innovation v. competition: how did regulation affect firm behavior via the Hatch-Waxman Act? Doctoral Dissertation, University of Illinois at Chicago. 2022. doi: 10.25417/uic.20254128.v1.

E. Policy Reports

Chaloupka F, Drope J, Siu E, Vulovic V, Mirza M, Rodriguez-Iglesias G, Ngo A, **Latarnser C**, Lee H, Dorokhina M, Smith M. Tobacconomics cigarette tax scorecard, 2nd edition: scoring component policy note—affordability change. Chicago, IL: Health Policy Center, Institute for Health Research and Policy, University of Illinois Chicago. 2021.

D. Conference Abstracts & Proceedings

Latarnser C*, Zdanowicz Z, Lay A, Woo J. Are discharge barriers responsible for insurance-based differences in length of stay after congenital heart surgery? *Circulation* 152(Suppl_3):A4370023. 2025. **Second Place Young Investigator Award, American Academy of Pediatrics.**

Latarnser C*, Grobman W, Albaro C, Anderson B, Batton B, Yee L, Woo J. Prenatal care and perinatal regionalization of congenital heart defect care. *Circulation* 152(Suppl_3):A4370165. 2025.

Karahalios DS, **Latarnser C**, Thrush P, Garg A, Morrison A, Mongé M, et al. Effect of pediatric heart transplant waitlist inactivation on waitlist and post-transplant outcomes. *Journal of Heart and Lung Transplantation* 44(4):S345. 2025.

Lockhart EN, Woo J, Cosantino A, **Latarnser C**, Joong A. Failed dental evaluations in pediatric heart transplant recipients. *Journal of the American College of Cardiology* 85(12_Supplement):756. 2025.

Woo J, Gotteiner N, Anderson B, Yee L, Grobman W, Davis M, **Latarnser C**. Is prenatal diagnosis responsible for differences in timing to postnatal intervention for critical congenital heart defects? *Circulation* 150(Suppl_1):A4139179. 2024.

Woo J, Gandhi R, **Latarnser C**, Iyengar T, Yee L, Grobman W, Davis M, et al. Performance of second-trimester ultrasound mediates the relationship between public insurance and prenatal diagnosis of a congenital heart defect. *AcademyHealth Annual Research Meeting*. 2024.

Boyd R, **Latarnser C**, Patel S, Migally K, Patel S. Fontan-related lymphatic complications are associated with extracardiac outcomes and morbidity. *Circulation* 150(Suppl_1):A4125294. 2024.

Tumuluru P, Lockhart E, Carr M, Kriegermeier A, **Latarnser C**, Patel S. Abnormal liver stiffness as a risk factor for elevated hemoglobin A1c in patients with Fontan physiology. *Circulation* 150(Suppl_1):A4146827. 2024.

Lawson A, Lee S, Popescu A, Tannous P, **Latarnser C**, Markl M, Rigsby C, et al. Myocardial perfusion reserve index in pediatric heart transplant recipients. *Circulation* 150(Suppl_1):A4142989. 2024.

Zellmer B, Polsen C, Husain N, **Latarnser C**, Jone PN. Comparison of strain injury and recovery between COVID-19 vaccine related myocarditis versus multisystem inflammatory syndrome in children (MIS-C). *Journal of the American Society of Echocardiography* 37(7):38. 2024.

Watanabe K, Haregu A, Arva N, **Latarnser C**, Husain N. Fibrosis and microvessel disease are common findings on endomyocardial biopsy in pediatric heart transplant recipients. *Journal of Heart and Lung Transplantation* 43(4):S466. 2024.

Watanabe K, Birjiniuk A, Crawford RL, Robinson JR, Magnetta D, Rigsby C, **Latarnser C**, Husain N. Relations between cardiac magnetic resonance imaging and cell free DNA in pediatric heart transplant—a pilot study for the future of heart transplant surveillance. *Journal of Heart and Lung Transplantation* 42(4):S482. 2023.

Kalb EM, **Latarnser C**, Monge M, Thrush P. Sensitized pediatric heart transplant recipients in a ten-year single center study. *Journal of Heart and Lung Transplantation* 42(4):S155. 2023.

Haregu A, Watanabe K, Ramlogan S, **Latarnser C**, et al. Novel parameters of left atrial function assessment in pediatric heart transplant recipients. *Journal of the American Society of Echocardiography* 36(7):e18. 2023.

Patel SR, Dababneh R, Bian Y, **Latarnser C**, Patel A, Patel SG. Inferior vena cava diameter by transthoracic echocardiography predicts catheter-based hemodynamics in single ventricle congenital heart defects patients with Fontan palliation. *Journal of the American Society of Echocardiography* 36(7):e25-e26. 2023.

Jacobson E, Carr M, Allen KY, Samis J, Torchen L, **Latarnser C**, Bian Y, et al. Prevalence of abnormal hemoglobin A1c values in single ventricle patients following Fontan palliation. *Journal of the American College of Cardiology* 81(8_Supplement):1571. 2023.

- Lawson AA, Tannous P, **Latarnser** C, Migally K. The Fick method with Lafarge estimates of oxygen consumption systematically over-estimates cardiac index when compared to thermodilution in children. *Circulation* 146(Suppl_1):A13590. 2022.
- Webster G, Coons DE, Carberry T, Chandler SF, Cherny S, Jacobson EN, **Latarnser** C, et al. Dose response and long QT genotype during exercise stress testing in children. *Circulation* 146(Suppl_1):A11237. 2022.
- Lawson AA, Watanabe K, Griffin L, **Latarnser** C, Markl M, Rigsby CK, et al. Prevalence of late gadolinium enhancement following pediatric heart transplantation increases with time since transplantation. *Circulation* 146(Suppl_1):A13193. 2022.